

SYMPTOMS OF DIGITAL OVERLOAD

FROM TODDLERS TO SENIORS, GAMERS TO PHONE ZOMBIES, DISCOVER THE ALARMING SIGNS OF DIGITAL OVERLOAD ACROSS DIFFERENT LIFE STAGES AND USER PROFILES



CHILD

A child today is often seen swiping through screens before they can even read. They're growing up in a digital-first environment.

- **Reduced Attention Span:** Struggling to focus on non-digital tasks or engaging in prolonged activities.
- **Irritability When Limited:** Shows signs of frustration or anger when devices are taken away or internet access is restricted.
- **Disturbed Sleep Patterns:** Difficulty in falling asleep or frequent waking during the night, potentially due to overstimulation from screen time.
- **Social Withdrawal:** Prefers interacting with devices over playing with other children, leading to less social development.
- **Physical Discomfort:** Experiences eye strain, headaches, or fatigue from prolonged screen exposure.



STUDENT

Students these days are digital natives, using technology for both learning and leisure. But the line between useful engagement and distraction is often blurred.

- **Procrastination:** Increasing delays in starting or completing assignments due to time spent on unrelated online activities.
- **Anxiety Over Notifications:** Constant need to check devices for fear of missing out on social updates or communications.
- **Memory Issues:** Trouble retaining information or concentrating during lectures due to fragmented attention from multitasking across devices.
- **Physical Symptoms:** Neck and back pain from poor posture during prolonged computer and smartphone use.
- **Decreased Academic Performance:** Grades start to suffer as more time is spent online rather than studying.



ADULT

In today's digital age, adults find themselves juggling numerous devices for both personal and professional use, struggling to maintain a balance.

- **Chronic Stress:** Feels constant tension from the need to stay connected and responsive.
- **Burnout:** Experiences exhaustion from the non-stop demands of digital multitasking, which often leads to a sense of feeling overwhelmed.
- **Inability to Unplug:** Struggles with disconnecting from digital devices, leading to work and social notifications creeping into personal and family time.
- **Reduced Productivity:** Difficulties in completing tasks efficiently due to frequent interruptions and distractions.
- **Social Isolation:** Misses out on physical interactions as digital engagements take precedence, impacting relationships and social life.



ELDER & SENIOR

Seniors are increasingly adopting technology to stay connected with family, manage health, or consume media. However, it can be both a blessing and a challenge for them.

- **Overwhelming Complexity:** Struggling to keep up with the rapid pace of technological changes and the multitude of platforms.
- **Social Dependence on Technology:** Over-reliance on digital forms of communication, leading to decreased face-to-face interactions with peers.
- **Privacy and Security Concerns:** Increased anxiety about privacy, security breaches, or scams online.
- **Sleep Disruption:** Altered sleep patterns due to increased screen time, especially when used to pass time during the night.
- **Cognitive Overload:** Difficulty processing too much information leading to mental fatigue.